Susanne Hansen

Senior Executive Assistant
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SUMMARY

Senior executive assistant with seven years supporting multiple senior leaders across functions and time zones, most recently two executive directors. Manages high-level, ever-changing calendars; books and troubleshoots domestic and international travel with firsthand knowledge from years as American Airlines inflight crew. Led an executive assistant team and rolled out the SOPs that put every new campus on one playbook; plans executive retreats and events. Three years as a fully remote strategic partner to health-tech founders and ed-tech leaders. AI-first: proposed and led AI readiness workshops, builds workflows that standardize repeat work, and runs a team of AI agents. Works in Gmail, Google Calendar, Zoom, and Slack; calm when plans change and discreet with confidential information.

EXPERIENCE

AI Operator · Independent Project — January 2026 – Present

A self-directed year of putting AI to work, including on a real health-tech use case.

- Brings AI into everyday knowledge work, including scheduling, the inbox, and meeting prep, and checks every result before it goes out.
- Designs and operates a team of AI agents across Claude, ChatGPT, and Grok, each with a defined role and a written runbook; keeps learning newer tools, including Gemini.
- Built one shared knowledge base every AI agent works from; confidential information is kept out by rule.
- Created one decision list for everything awaiting review or approval: each item says what it is, where to find it, and exactly what's needed, so decisions don't stall or get lost.
- Knows which work to hand to AI and which has to stay with a person; the work stays visible and moves only with approval.

Senior Executive Assistant · The Village Church, Flower Mound, Texas — January 2024 – December 2025

Hybrid. Strategic partner to the Executive Directors of Operations and of Engagement and Communications in a large multi-site organization. Worked across Communications and Marketing, and Technology and Operations.

- Owned two competing high-volume executive calendars as one integrated plan, prioritizing requests, resolving conflicts, and protecting prep time before high-visibility meetings.
- Planned executive retreats and supported the leadership team's meeting rhythm: handled logistics and prepared agendas, briefing materials, presentations, and talking points; turned notes into executive summaries and tracked decisions, action items, owners, and deadlines to completion.
- Managed an executive inbox with a global audience: filtered and flagged, drafted replies and correspondence for signature, and surfaced only what needed the executive.
- Coordinated vendor, architect, and construction meetings and supported Operations budget preparation for a multi-year, multi-campus buildout.
- Helped onboard new hires and kept priorities, commitments, and relationships steady through executive and administrative staff turnover.
- Proposed an AI readiness program, recruited the people who wanted in, and led the workshops; in Communications and Marketing, ran a one-on-one discovery session with each team member. Served on the three-person executive team for AI implementation and use policy.
- After a restructuring, stepped in as a de facto consultant and built role-specific workflows that helped Communications and Marketing through 45% departmental turnover in four months.

Executive Ghostwriter · Independent Contractor January 2022 – December 2024

Fully remote. Strategic partner to clients including health-tech founders and ed-tech leaders.

- Managed projects, timelines, and client expectations in close collaboration with each principal's product and technology teams.
- Shaped the narrative, then wrote the thought leadership, presentations, and book chapters published under each principal's name, in strict confidence.

Inflight Crew · American Airlines May 2018 – December 2022

A long-held goal, pursued between executive roles.

- Delivered calm, professional service on domestic and international routes on a schedule that changed constantly, including the days the operation broke down; learned from the inside where an itinerary fails and how to plan around it.
- Saw a communication gap between the crew on the line and the administration, and was selected to work with the administration on in-flight crew policy training and compliance.

Senior Executive Assistant · Bent Tree Church, Carrollton, Texas January 2013 – May 2018

A large Dallas-based church with campuses in two states. Gatekeeper and high-touch support for the Senior Pastor on a local and international speaking schedule; also supported the operational team and the board.

- Owned the calendar, speaking engagements, and all domestic and international travel, including remote regions, from booking through travel risk and security, and stayed on call while the Senior Pastor traveled.
- Led the executive assistant team and provided back-up support when a teammate was out; also led other initiatives and projects from research through training and implementation.
- Sat on the strategic team for a multi-campus expansion and led the communications and SOP work to open a new campus: brought in staff from the other sites to train the new team on values and culture, routed all communication through the main office, and put every campus on one playbook.
- Served as the first point of contact for staff, guests, donors, and public-relations contacts, screening requests and declining what didn't belong on the calendar.
- Managed donor relations and events in support of a $22 million fundraiser; hosted visiting speakers and coordinated their green room with the event staff.

EARLIER CAREER

Operations Manager (3+ years, 3 direct reports) · Financial Analyst, Arthur Andersen / Accenture · Statistical Forecasting and Analysis, Mary Kay Cosmetics

TOOLS

Google Workspace (Gmail, Calendar, Drive, Docs, Sheets) · Zoom, Slack · Asana, Notion · Mac · AI: Claude, ChatGPT, Grok, Gemini, Microsoft Copilot · Microsoft Office (Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Teams), SharePoint, OneDrive

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Business Administration, Accounting · Southern Methodist University, Dallas, Texas

LANGUAGES

English and Danish

TRAVEL

Valid passport and active driver's license; happy to travel domestically and internationally.